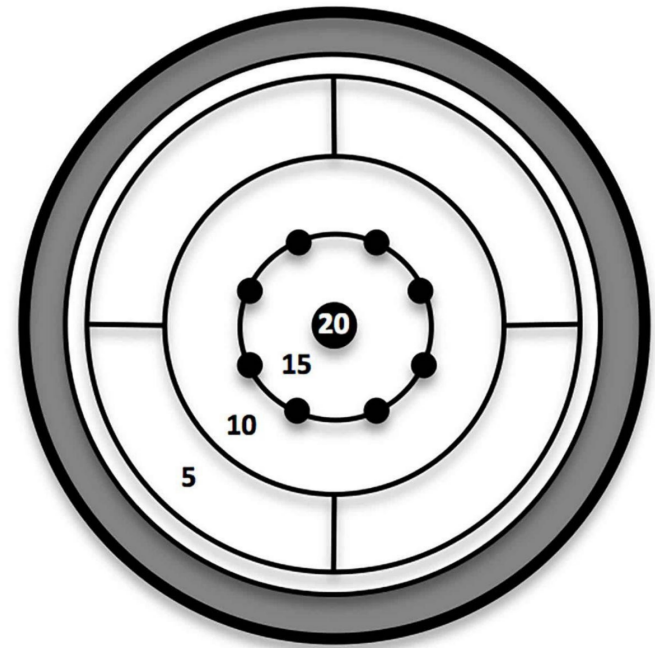
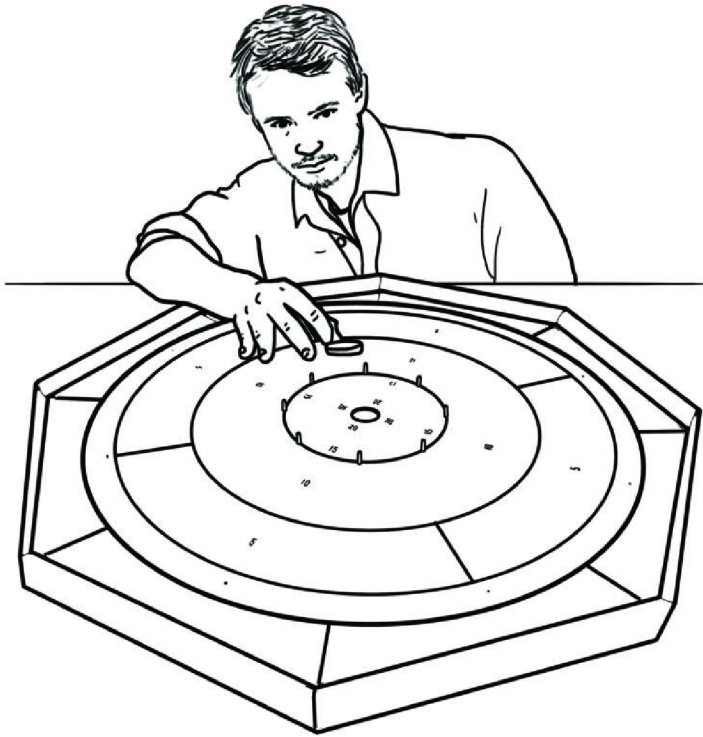


Crokinole

Official Rules and a Brief History



- Rules were directly taken from the National Crokinole Association website in 2022 -
- History and Origins of the Name passages were taken from Wikipedia -

Rules of Crokinole

The following rules are sanctioned by the National Crokinole Association and used in all NCA Tour events.

Basic Rules of Play

1. Getting Ready
 - a. A player or team's initial order of play, color of discs, and seating position, shall be determined by chance or by the organizer(s) of a club or tournament.
2. How to play
 - a. A "round" shall proceed as follows:
 - i. Each player, in turn, proceeding clockwise around the board, shall attempt to make a "valid shot". (See Rule 3)
 - ii. After each turn, any 20s sunk shall be removed and placed in a designated area visible to all players and must remain there until the end of the round.
 - iii. At the end of the round, the score on the board shall be counted along with the 20s, before any discs may be moved.
 - iv. The player or team with the higher score shall receive 2 points. If the round is tied, each player or team shall receive 1 point.
 - b. A "game" shall consist of 4 rounds.
 - c. The number of games in a "match" shall be determined by the tournament rules.
3. Valid Shot
 - a. Definition
 - i. If any opposing discs are in play, at least one of the shooter's discs must strike an opposing disc either directly, or by bumping one of his/her discs already in play into an opposing disc.

A Brief History of Crokinole

After 30 years of research, Wayne Kelly published his assessment of the first origins of crokinole, in *The Crokinole Book*,^[7] Third Edition, page 28, which leaves the door open to future research and discovery of the origins of the game of crokinole: "The earliest American crokinole board and reference to the game is M. B. Ross's patented New York board of 1880. The earliest Canadian reference is 1867(*Sports and Games in Canadian Life: 1700 to the Present* by Howell and Howell,^[8] Toronto, MacMillan Company of Canada, 1969, p.61, and the oldest piece dated at 1875 by Eckhardt Wettlaufer.^[9] Could Eckhardt Wettlaufer have visited friends in New York state, noticed an unusual and entertaining parlour game being played, and upon arrival at home, made an imitation as a gift for his son? After all, he was a talented, and no doubt resourceful, painter and woodworker. Or was it the other way around? Did Mr. M. B. Ross travel to Ontario, take note of a quaint piece of rural folk art, and upon return to New York, put his American entrepreneurial skills to work - complete with patent name - on his new crokinole board? As the trail is more than 100 years old and no other authoritative source can be found, it appears, at the moment, that Eckhardt Wettlaufer or M. B. Ross are as close as we can get to answering the question WHO (made the first crokinole board.)"

The earliest known crokinole board was made by craftsman [Eckhardt Wettlaufer](#) in 1876 in [Perth County, Ontario](#), Canada. It is said Wettlaufer crafted the board as a fifth birthday present for his son Adam, which is now part of the collection at the [Joseph Schneider](#) Haus, a national historic site in Kitchener, Ontario, with a focus on Germanic folk art.^[10] Several other home-made boards dating from southwestern Ontario in the 1870s have been discovered since the 1990s. A board game similar to crokinole was patented on 20 April 1880 by Joshua K. Ingalls (US Patent No. 226,615)^{[11][12]}^[unreliable source]

Origins of the name

The name "crokinole" derives from *croquignole*, a French word today designating:

1. in France, a kind of [cookie](#) (or [biscuit](#) in British English),^[15] similar to a [biscotto](#);
2. in [French Canada](#), a pastry somewhat similar to a [doughnut](#) (except for the shape).^{[17][18]}

It also used to designate the action of flicking with the finger ([Molière](#), *Le malade imaginaire*; or [Voltaire](#), *Lettre à Frédéric II Roi de Prusse*; etc.), and this seems the most likely origin of the name of the game. *Croquignole* was also a synonym of *pichenotte*, a word that gave its name to the different but related games of [pichenotte](#) and [pitchnut](#).

From The Crokinole Book 3rd Edition^[2] by Wayne S. Kelly "Is it possible that the English word 'crokinole' is simply an etymological offspring of the French word '[croquignole](#)'? It would appear so for the following reasons. Going back to the entry for Crokinole in Webster's Third New International Dictionary, within the etymological brackets is says: [French [croquignole](#), [fillip](#)].^[19] This is a major clue. The word fillip, according to Webster's, has two definitions: "1. a blow or gesture made by the sudden forcible release of a finger curled up against the thumb; a short sharp blow. 2. to strike by holding the nail of a finger curled up against the ball of the thumb and then suddenly releasing it from that position". So it seems evident, then, that our game of crokinole derives its name from the verb form (of *croquignole*) defining the principle action in the game, that of flicking or 'filliping' a playing piece across the board".

The word Crokinole is generally acknowledged to have been derived from the French Canadian word "[Croquignole](#)",^[20] a word with several meanings,^[21] such as fillip, snap, biscuit, bun and a [woman's wavy hairstyle](#) popular at the turn of the century. The US state of New York shares border crossings with both of the Canadian provinces of Ontario and Quebec, all three of which are popular "hotbeds" of Crokinole playing.

Crokinole is called *knipsbrat* ('flick-board') (and occasionally *knipsdesh* (flick-table)) in the [Plautdietsch](#) spoken by [Russian Mennonites](#).

- ii. If there are no opposing discs in play, then the shooting disc or at least one disc struck during the shot must end up touching or within the 15 line. (*The No Hiding Rule*) (A 20 is considered within the 15 line)
- b. If on any turn, a valid shot is not made, then the shooting disc and all of the other discs that were struck, including any 20s made, shall be removed, considered out-of-play, and shall not score.

Additional Rules

4. Singles

- a. Opponents shall sit on opposite sides of the board and each have a different color of discs. Players shall each begin with 8 discs, and shall alternate turns.
- b. In each of the rounds in a game, players shall alternate starting. In each of the games in a multi-game match between 2 players, players shall alternate starting.
- c. A singles player is not allowed to be coached during play.

5. Doubles

- a. Partners shall sit on opposite sides of the board and play the same color of discs, which shall be different from the color of their opponents discs. If a team is chosen to play first, the partners may decide which of them shall start. Players shall each begin with 6 discs.
- b. In each subsequent round in a game, the obligation to start shall move one player clockwise around the board. In each of the games in a multi-game match between 2 teams, the teams shall alternate starting.
- c. A doubles player may be coached only by his partner during play.

6. Scoring

- a. The center hole shall count 20, the region around it 15, the next region (outside the pegs) 10 and the outer region 5.

- b. A disc shall score the lowest value of any region of the board that it is touching.
- c. In order to score 20, a disc must be completely in the center hole and lying flat.
- d. If a disc is touching a line, it scores the lower value of the two regions adjacent to the line.
- e. If a disc is lying flat on the board, the determining factor in deciding whether it is touching a line is whether the bottom edge of the disc is over any part of the line (not by where the edge of the disc appears to be when viewed from above).

7. Shooting

- a. During an opponent's turn, a player may not touch the board, or table, or place a disc in position, or make any unusual noise or motion designed to distract that player.
- b. During a shot, only the player's shooting hand, and associated wrist, and forearm may touch the board or table.
- c. Before shooting, a player must wait until all motion of the discs from the previous turn has ceased.
- d. A disc must start from a flat, stationary position, and be touching some part of the outer boundary line of the player's quadrant, or touching both the outer boundary line and a player's quadrant dividing line.
- e. A disc must be struck by one or more fingers. No aids, such as finger guards, are permitted.
- f. Intentional or excessive shaking of the board with the shooting hand, or by any other means, is not permitted.
- g. Once a player has his finger and disc in a set position in preparation for a shot, and the disc leaves his/her finger, a shot is judged to have taken place.
- h. Neither the board, nor the chair, of any player may be moved while the game is in progress, except that a player may move his chair, if necessary, to pick up a disc that has fallen out of reach.

- i. When a player is shooting, at least one portion of his/her posterior must be in contact with the seat of his/her chair.
- j. Each leg of a player's chair must be in contact with the floor. (no leaning of the chair)
- k. No part of a player's body except the feet may touch the floor. No other means of support may be utilized.

8. Other

- a. Granular shuffleboard wax shall be placed in the ditch so that players may rub their disc in the wax prior to shooting. It may be applied to the playing surface by tournament officials (and only by tournament officials), if in their opinion, conditions warrant it. No other lubricant is allowed.
- b. If time runs out in a timed match, one additional shot will be allowed, if necessary, to equalize the number of shots.
- c. If a disc touches or crosses the outer boundary line it is out-of-play. (Subject to 8e)
- d. If a disc is out-of-play, it shall be placed in the ditch before the next player's turn, and must remain there until the end of the round.
- e. The Spinning Disc Rule - If a disc touches or crosses the outer boundary line and does not strike anything other than the playing surface while touching or across the outer boundary line, and returns under its own momentum to end up within the outer boundary line, it will be considered still in play.
- f. The Damage Stays Rule - If a disc touches or crosses the outer boundary line, strikes the backboard and/or out-of-play discs, then re-enters the playing surface this disc is out-of-play, but the altered position of any discs struck shall remain and any 20s made shall count. (except for an out-of-play disc)